

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear equations in two variables	Easy

Question

A total of **364** paper straws of equal length were used to construct two types of polygons: triangles and rectangles. The triangles and rectangles were constructed so that no two polygons had a common side. The equation $3x + 4y = 364$ represents this situation, where x is the number of triangles constructed and y is the number of rectangles constructed. What is the best interpretation of $(x, y) = (24, 73)$ in this context?

Answer

- A. If **24** triangles were constructed, then **73** rectangles were constructed.
- B. If **24** triangles were constructed, then **73** paper straws were used.
- C. If **73** triangles were constructed, then **24** rectangles were constructed.
- D. If **73** triangles were constructed, then **24** paper straws were used.

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is correct. It's given that **364** paper straws of equal length were used to construct triangles and rectangles, where no two polygons had a common side. It's also given that the equation $3x + 4y = 364$ represents this situation, where x is the number of triangles constructed and y is the number of rectangles constructed. The equation $(x, y) = (24, 73)$ means that if $x = 24$, then $y = 73$. Substituting **24** for x and **73** for y in $3x + 4y = 364$ yields $3(24) + 4(73) = 364$, or $364 = 364$, which is true. Therefore, in this context, the equation $(x, y) = (24, 73)$ means that if **24** triangles were constructed, then **73** rectangles were constructed.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual errors.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual errors.